

The Samurai

Adapt to the flow of combat with this homebrew martial class



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THE SAMURAI



TANDING ALONE BENEATH A BARREN LADSCAPE, A HUMAN FACES DOWN A LEGION OF ORC SOLDIERS WITH A SINGLE BLADE IN HAND, HIS LIEGE, A 10-YEAR OLD PRINCE, QUIVERING BEHIND HIM. Hidden in the shadows of a mansion's ceiling, an elven spy watches a gathering of lords having a wat council, taking notes on their battle strategies. He keeps his set of bizarre equipment close to him, ready to scape at a moment's notice.

Talismans in hand, a dragonborn priest summons spirit animals that hold down a demon-possessed civilian. A blaze of fire suddenly silences de demon's cries, as he finally draws out the creature that's been terrorizing the village.

Beholden by an oath no dissimilar to a knight, Samurai pledge their services to a single individual, devoting their life to their cause. No matter the vast differrences in treir chosen lord, Samurai undergo a specialized training that focus on a certain set of skills, skills that are sometimes as varied as the lord they choose to serve. Whether skilled warriors who master the art of the blade, subterfuge experts trained in gathering intel and assassination, or learned arcanists who channel divine energy through esoteric implements, Samurai are renowned and respected by their unering dedication to their craft.

A LOYAL VASSAL

Samurai more often than not, enter into the service of a lord when they begin their training. Perhaps they're apprenticed into the lord of the land, or a family member has taken them up for training, whichever the case, Samurai spend their early training days working closely with their liege.

Their oath is bound by honor. Thus, they perform their services until their death and nothing would bring a Samurai greater shame than being dishonorably dismissed. Their master's death is no reason for a Samurai's duty to ente either. Most Samurai pass on their services to their master's family, or to someone that their ma+ster deems close. A few of them become lords themselves and even fewer settel down and retire.

MULTICLASSING

You need a Strength and Dexterity of 13 to multiclass in and out of this class.

Proficiencies: Light armor, Simple Weapons, Martial Weapons, Calligrapher's Tools, Smith's Tools.

DISTANT WANDERERS

In an event that a Samurai becomes without a lord, they might prefer to continue their duties on their own, drifting from one place to another, only stopping at an area to replenish their supplies or take a brief respite.

These Samurai are referred to as **Ronin**, someone who finds the way without belonging to one place. They can often be seen living and traveling amongst the commonfolk, assisting them in times of trouble and defending their vilages from bandits and raiders.

These Samurai live a simpler life, but their hearts remain ready for the call of adventure.



SAMURAI WEAPONS

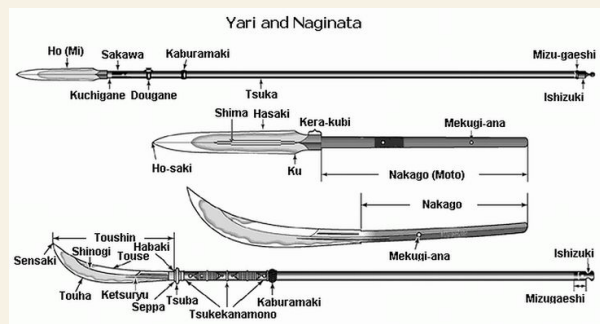
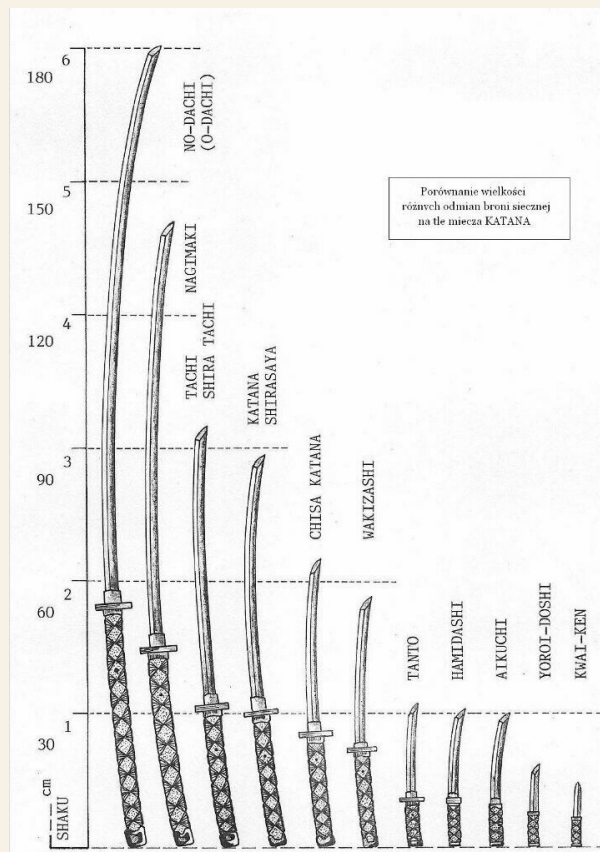
Those who follow the code of Samurai, come from all walks of life, but its true origins lie in an archaic culture tha existed long ago. If you wish to create a Samurai that comes from that path, here are some of the names and descriptions of the weapons they choose to wield. Whatever names you use for a Samurai Weapon, you can use the game statics provided for the weapon on the weapons page of the Player's Handbook.

SAMURAI WEAPONS

Name	Description
Bo (quarterstaff)	A staff made from unfinished hard wood or a flexible wood, such as red or white oak
Kama (Sickle)	A farming implement similar to a sickle, used for reaping crops and also employed as weapon
Kanabo (Warhammer)	A spiked or studded two-handed war club
Katana (Longsword)	A curved, single-edged blade with a circular or squared guard and long grip to accommodate to hands. The trademark of the Samurai
Kusari-fundo (Flail)	A hand-held weapon consisting of a length of chain (kusari) with a weight (fundo) attached to each end of the chain
Naginata (Glave)	A pole weapon that consists of a wooden or metal pole with a curved, single-edged blade on the end
Odachi (Greatsword)	A traditionally made katana with a longer and heavier blade
Otsuchi (Maul)	A large wooden mallet
Tanto (Dagger)	A dagger that Samurai use as a last resort or self-defense
Wakizashi (Shortsword)	A smaller version of the katana. Often seen as a pair together with the katana called Daisho (Big and Small)
Yari (Spear)	A form of straight headed spear. Yari often have varied points of blade attached to its tip
Yumi (Longbow)	An assimetrical bow that's exceptionally tall

MASTERY

Each Samurai weapon can use the the mastery of the correspondent classical weapon of the Player's Handbook



SAMURAI

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Level	PB	Features	Heaven	Earth	Man	Mastery
1st	+2	Stance, First step, Mastery	1d4	10ft.	+2	2
2nd	+2	Elegant Courtier, Fighting Style	1d4	10ft.	+2	2
3rd	+2	Samurai Discipline Feature	1d4	10ft.	+2	2
4th	+2	Ability Score Improvement, Martial Versatility	1d4	10ft.	+2	3
5th	+3	Extra Attack, Precise Strike	1d6	10ft.	+3	3
6th	+3	First Step Improvement, Ascended Stance	1d6	15ft.	+3	3
7th	+3		1d6	15ft.	+3	3
8th	+3		1d6	15ft.	+3	3
9th	+4		1d6	15ft.	+3	3
10th	+4		1d6	15ft.	+3	4
11th	+4		1d8	15ft.	+4	4
12th	+4		1d8	15ft.	+4	4
13th	+5		1d8	20ft.	+4	4
14th	+5		1d8	20ft.	+4	4
15th	+5		1d8	20ft.	+4	4
16th	+5		1d8	20ft.	+4	4
17th	+6		1d10	20ft.	+5	4
18th	+6		1d10	20ft.	+5	4
19th	+6		1d10	20ft.	+5	4
20th	+6		1d10	30ft.	+5	4



The Hammer of Justice

CLASS FEATURES

As a Samurai, you gain the following class features

HIT POINTS

Hit Dice: 1d10 per Samurai Level

Hit Points at 1st Level: 10 + your Constitution modifier

Hit Points at higher levels: 1d10(or 6) + your Constitution modifier per Samurai level after 1st

PROFICIENCIES

Armor: Light and medium armors

Weapons: Simple and martial weapons

Tools: Calligrapher's and Smith's tools

Saving Throws: Strength and Constitution

Skills: Choose two from Athletics, Acrobatics, Insight, Intimidation, Persuasion, Perception

EQUIPMENT

You start with the following equipment, in addition to the equipment granted by your background:

- (a) scale mail or (b) leather armor
- (a) a longsword and a shortsword or (b) two martial weapons
- (a) a diplomat's pack or (b) a explorer's pack
- (a) calligrapher tools or (b) smith's tools
- longbow and 20 arrows

STANCE

Your unique training gives you access to stances that let you adapt to any situation. On your turn, before you attack, you can enter a stance as a bonus action.

While in a stance, you gain benefits based on the stance of your choice, provided that you aren't yousing a shield.

Heaven. The heavenly stance, high and mighty, deliver intense and powerfull strikes, designed to cut down even strongest foes.

- Your weapon damage rolls deal an extra 1d4 damage, which you roll twice when you crit. This damage die increases by one size - e.g 1d4 to 1d6 - when you use a two handed melee weapon or a longbow to make an attack.

Earth. The earth stance, sturdy as a rock, maintains a steady and balanced footing, letting you move swiftly across the battlefield.

- Your speed is increased by 10ft.
- When you make a melee attack against a creature and hit, you don't provoke opportunity attacks from that creature for the rest of the turn.

Man. The stance of Man, lowly and cautious, favor defensive posturs that let you evade or mitigate the damage you receive.

- Whenever you make a Dexterity saving throw while in this stance, you can roll a d4 and add the number rolled to the saving throw.
- You gain a +2 bonus to AC.

Your stance lasts for one minute, until you enter a diferent stance, or until you are incapacitated. You can also end your stance on your turn as a bonus action.

The bonuses you gain from your stances increase when reach certain Samurai levels, as show in the Samurai Table.

FIRST STEP

At first level, your first step is quicker than most, thanks in part to your martial acuity. You gain a bonus to your initiative rolls equal to your proficiency bonus.

Starting at 6th level, if you are surprised at the beginning of combat and aren't incapacitated, you can act normally on your first turn, but only if you enter a stance before doing anything else on that turn.

At 13th level, your unmached speed and discipline gives you advantage on initiative rolls.

WEAPON MASTERY

Your training with Samurai weapons allows you to use mastery properties with two types of weapons of your choice, such as kamas or odachis. Whenever you finish a long rest, you can practice and replace one of these weapon choices.

As you reach certain Samurai levels, you gain additional weapon choices, as shown in the Samurai table.

ELEGANT COURTIER

Starting at 2nd level, your discipline and attention to detail allow you to excel in social situations. Whenever you make a Charisma(Persuasion) check, you gain a bonus to the check equal to your wisdom modifier.

At 11th level, your self-control also causes you to gain proficiency in wisdom saving throws. If you already have this proficiency, you instead gain proficiency in Intelligence or Charisma saving throws (your choice).

FIGHTING STYLE

At 2nd level, you adopt a particular style of fighting as your specialty. Choose one of the following options. You can't take a Fighting Style option more than once, even if you later get to choose again.

- **Archery:** You gain a +2 bonus to attack rolls you make with ranged weapons.
- **Blind Fighting:** You have blindsight with a range of 10 feet. Within that range, you can effectively see anything that isn't behind total cover, even if you are blinded or in darkness. Moreover, you can see an invisible creature within that range, unless the creature successfully hides from you.
- **Dueling:** When you are wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapons, you gain a +2 bonus to damage rolls with that weapon.
- **Great Weapon Fighting:** When you roll a 1 or 2 on damage die for an attack made with a melee weapon that you are wielding with two hands, you can reroll the die and must use the new roll, even if you rolled a 1 or 2. The weapon must have the two-handed or versatile property for you to gain this benefit.
- **Throw Weapon Fighting:** You can draw a weapon that has the throw property as part of the attack you make with the weapon. In addition, when you hit with a ranged attack, you gain a +2 bonus to the damage roll.
- **Two-Weapon Fighting:** When you engage in two-weapon fighting, you can add your ability modifier to the damage of the second attack.

At 10th level, you can choose an additional Fighting Style.

SAMURAI DISCIPLINE

At 3rd level you choose the type of School you specialize in. Your choice grants you features at 3rd level and again at 9th, 15th and 20th level.

ABILITY SCORE IMPROVEMENT

When you reach 4th level, and again at 8th, 12th and 16th level you can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or you can choose 2 ability scores to increase by 1. As normal, you can't increase an ability score above 20 using this feature.

MARTIAL VERSATILITY

Whenever you reach a level in this class that grants you Ability Score Improvement feature, you can replace a fighting style you know with another fighting style available to Samurai. This replacement represents a shift of focus in your martial practice.

EXTRA ATTACK

Beginning at 5th level, you can attack twice, instead of once, whenever you take the attack action on your turn.

PRECISE STRIKE

Starting at 5th level, you've become adept at turning your failures into advantage.

When you miss a creature with a weapon attack, your next attack against that creature is made with advantage.

ASCENDED STANCE

Beginning at 6th level, you can activate a stance's **Kai**. For 1 minute, this stance has additional benefits, along with the features it initially provides.

Heaven Kai: When you deal the additional damage of your Heaven stance, you can roll two dice instead of just one, adding both to the roll. If the target is incapacitated, prone or restrained, you deal maximum damage with both dice, instead of rolling them.

Earth Kai:

Man Kai: